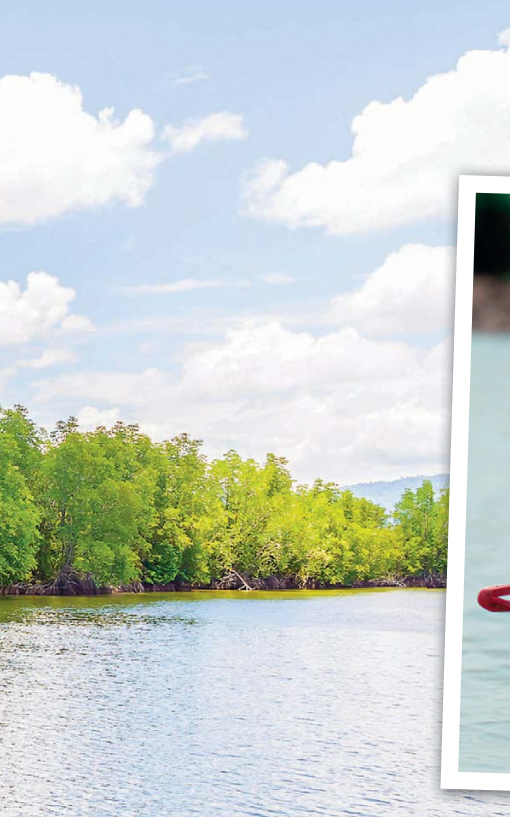




hood to millions. The plantation project provides sustainable alternative livelihood to local fishermen in the off-season months. Steps are taken to minimise the adverse effects of the unsustainable anthropogenic activities detrimental to this environment.

Maintaining Coastal Ecosystem

In line with the goal to build resilience towards climate change and commitment to reduce impact on the environment, several measures are undertaken by APSEZ, which has signed the India Business and Biodiversity Initiative (IBBI) declaration to act responsibly in several biodiversity areas such as target setting, inclusion in management systems, and engagement with stakeholders.

The company identifies biodiversity impacts and uses Comprehensive Environmental Impact Assessment to focus on terrestrial and marine life. As a signatory to the initiative, which is a commitment by the Board, biodiversity automatically features as a top agenda of the Board.

Pledge to Grow 100 million Trees by 2030

Adani Ports strives to undertake green initiatives in line with the broad vision of the nation, and also adheres with International Marine Organization's alignment to nine UN Sustainable Developmental Goals (SDGs), which includes obligations on safe, efficient and sustainable ports.

On 1t.org, the World Economic Forum's "Trillion Trees Platform", Mr Gautam Adani pledged to grow 100 million trees by 2030. This commitment makes it one of the most ambitious corporate commitments ever made (<https://www.1t.org/pledges/growing-100-million-trees-by-2030>) to 1t.org so far. The 100 million would include mangroves as well as terrestrial trees.

Strategic Steps to Protect Environment

Along its more than 7,500 kilometres of coastline, India is blessed with a variety of coastal and marine ecosystems that offer a wide range of services like fisheries, coastal tourism, and other essential livelihood activities. Mangroves and sand dunes provide protection from storms and tsunamis.

A bio-shield has been developed on the seacoast in Tankari village of Jambusar taluka in Gujarat's Bharuch district. Mangrove plantation, protected by natural bamboo fencing, helps protect the seacoast, boost fisheries and overall biodiversity in the region. Similarly, at Yarada beach near Gangavaram port in Visakhapatnam, beach nourishment work to combat soil erosion and protect infrastructure and natural surroundings.

Dhamra Port in Odisha is supporting the forest department's initiative to conserve Kanika Island by mangrove and casuarina plantation, channel cleaning, etc. Since it is a nesting ground for rare Olive Ridley Turtles – recognised as vulnerable by the IUCN Red list – a corpus has been created for their conservation and protection.

The green initiatives undertaken across all ports are well on track to make the ports cleaner and greener. It is also a key component of 'blue economy', which has been defined by the World Bank as "sustainable use of ocean resources for economic growth, improved livelihoods and jobs, while preserving the health of the ocean ecosystem".

